

Two Piles

Sort the load. Carry what's yours. Set down the rest.

A SHORT PARABLE

A man walked to town with two sacks on his back. One held bread for his family. The other was full of stones he'd picked up along the road — other men's insults, yesterday's mistakes, worries about rain. An old woman at the well asked, "Why carry the stones?" He said, "I didn't know I could put them down."

You can. Carry the bread. Set down the stones.

MY PILE

I CARRY THIS

- ☐ **My words**
What I say, and how I say it.
- ☐ **My effort**
Showing up and doing the work in front of me.
- ☐ **My attention**
Where I point my eyes, mind, and phone.
- ☐ **My repentance**
Owning my wrong and turning back.
- ☐ **My kindness**
How I treat the person in front of me.
- ☐ **My next right step**
One small thing I can do today.

NOT MY PILE

I SET THIS DOWN

- ☐ **Other people's moods**
I can be kind; I can't make them happy.
- ☐ **Outcomes**
I plant and water; I don't control the harvest.
- ☐ **The past**
I learn from it. I don't live in it.
- ☐ **Likes, views, and follows**
Numbers aren't my worth.
- ☐ **The weather**
Rain comes either way. Bring a coat.
- ☐ **What others think of me**
Their opinion is theirs to carry.

HOW TO USE IT · 60 SECONDS

1. **Name the weight.**
What's heavy on you right now?
2. **Ask one question:**
Is this mine to carry?
3. **Act or release.**
If it's yours, take one step. If it's not, set it down — and pray it over.

STOIC

"Some things are within our power, while others are not."

— Epictetus, Enchiridion 1

SCRIPTURE

"Casting all your care upon him; for he careth for you."

— 1 Peter 5:7 (KJV)

Carry only what's yours.

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